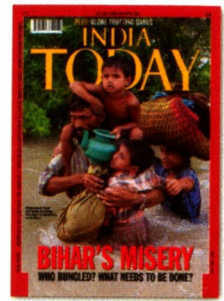


RAVI S SAHANI



**"Bihar's Misery",
September 15, 2008
"Bihar's misery is not a
natural disaster, but a
man-made calamity. It is
an example of extreme
human avarice, sheer
callousness and
disgusting blame game."**

AMITABH THAKUR, Lucknow

Tiding Over

Statistics about the enormity of people's woes, inadequacy of relief measures and ineptitude of flood control organisations are alarming enough to invite a probe by a parliamentary committee or the judges of the Supreme Court ("Bihar's Misery", September 15). It is a paradox that in spite of our global reputation for rich human capital in engineering, science and public administration, we have not been able to control, if not eliminate, the misery of Bihar's floods year after year. We have failed miserably on this count. Y.G. CHOUKSEY, Pune

Bihar has the notorious reputation of being indifferent. It is known for its culture of negligence and in the present context, the misery can be largely attributed to human follies than to nature's fury. The

floods could have been avoided, had the authorities cared to carry out annual monitoring and maintenance of the embankment. But they chose to remain indifferent like always. In addition, the indifferent attitude of the Nepal Government is highly deplorable. If such disasters can't be avoided, they can surely be averted. SUNNY AKHOURI, on e-mail

It's not the time for politicians to indulge in mud-slinging. They should rather use their time, energy and money in mobilising people to carry out relief work on war-footing. If they can gather thousands for their rallies and dharnas, why can't they manage to bring together a small per cent of human resources to speed up rescue, relief and rehabilitation in flood-affected areas of Bihar? P.K. SRIVASTAVA, on e-mail

Distributing food, clothing and shelter to the flood-affected people would at the best provide temporary relief, not a permanent solution. Any initiative to deal with a cataclysmic disaster effectively requires strong political will, besides sound and sensitive technology coupled with proactive administrative support. ROSHAN KUMAR AGARWAL, on e-mail

Rising Dragon

China's impressive medal tally in the recent Olympics is indicative of the country's resolve to excel in all fields of development, including sports ("China's Great Leap", September 8). Despite being a communist country, China's progress story speaks volumes about its ability to mould itself according to changing trends and emerging opportunities. Sadly, this wisdom is yet to dawn on the Left parties

in our country.

S. LAKSHMI, on e-mail

China has won on both counts—first, by organising such a grand sporting extravaganza and second, for such a stellar performance by its participants. To emulate this success model, sweeping changes are required—ensuring quality infrastructure and resources, nurturing young talents by providing good training and coaching facilities, and getting the sporting bodies rid of political interference and nepotism. RAMESH AGARWAL, Kanpur

China with its spectacular success in the Beijing Games has shown the world that there are two types of sports: sports and Chinese sports. But going for gold the Chinese way has its own hazards. Unlike the US where the primary motive of playing is pleasure and winning a medal doesn't make much of a